

Islamic Videos on the Human Heart & Soul (Nafs)

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Purpose: Curated, research-backed video index for deepening Islamic understanding of the human heart (qalb) and soul (nafs) — its nature, levels, diseases, and purification (tazkiyah).

Compiled: 2026-08-19 | **Sources:** Web research across YouTube, Islamicity, Kalamullah, Zaynab Academy, Life With Allah, and related Islamic platforms.

Note: All hyperlinks are clickable in this PDF. Entries marked *text* are companion articles (non-video) included for reference.

1. Core: The Soul & Self (Ruh & Nafs)

#	Title	Scholar / Speaker	Language	Short Description	Link
1	The Soul & Self (Ruh & Nafs)	Sheikh Belal Assad	English	Foundational 1h+ lecture; praised for clarity and actionability	Open
2	The Soul and Self (Ruh and Nafs)	Sheikh Belal Assad	English	Preston Mosque Lecture Series; also on Apple Podcasts (1h 6min)	Open
3	Know Yourself — Soul and Self	Belal Assaad	English	Explains what the Soul (Ruh) and Self (Nafs) are	Open
4	Nafs in Islam: How It Can Lift You Up or Bring You Down	Bilal Assad	English	The nafs as the pivotal concept for the soul's journey	Open

	Eye Opening!				
	What are				
5	Nafs (The Self) & Ruh (The Soul)	Belal Assad	English	Podcast/audio version of the core lecture	Open
	نفس کی حقیقت اور اسکی چال				
6	— The Reality of Nafs	Dr. Tahirul Qadri	Urdu	The physical self loves the world; the soul loves Allah	Open
	What are we made of according				
7	to Quran? Body, Soul, Nafs, Heart	Belal Assad (clip)	English	Short clip: the human being = body, soul, nafs, heart	Open

2. Purification of the Heart & Soul (Tazkiyah)

#	Title	Scholar / Speaker	Language	Short Description	Link
8	How to Purify Your Heart & Truly Reach Allah	Dr. Haifaa Younis	English	Practical purification guidance; also “2 Daily Habits to Purify Your Heart & Soul”	Open
9	What is the ‘Heart’ and How Does One Cleanse It?	Shaykh Dr. Yasir Qadhi	English	Definition of the heart and its cleansing (EPIC Masjid)	Open
10	Purification of the Soul: Importance and Techniques (Jummah Khutbah)	Shaykh Dr. Yasir Qadhi	English	Khutbah on tazkiyah importance and techniques	Open
11	Khutbah: Spiritual Purification	Dr. Yasir Qadhi	English	Related to Hamza Yusuf’s “Purification of	Open

	<u>of the Heart</u>				the Heart” 41-session series	
12	<u>Dua and Its Role in Purifying the Soul — Heart Matters: EP 5</u>	Yasir Qadhi / Hamza Yusuf	English	Dua as a purification mechanism	<u>Open</u>	
13	<u>Root to Purifying the Heart is Adab</u>	Shaykh Hamza Yusuf	English	Adab as the foundation required for heart purification	<u>Open</u>	
14	<u>The Path to Paradise — Tazkiyah Nafs (Purification of the Soul)</u>	Islamic Institute of Toronto	English	Streamed lecture on tazkiyah	<u>Open</u>	
15	<u>Tazkiyah and the Purification of the Soul — The 3 Levels of Din</u>	Heart Therapy series	English	Explores the self in detail; curing and perfecting the heart	<u>Open</u>	
16	<u>Shari’ah meaning of Tazkiyyah, Rooh & Nafs</u>	Sheikh Dr. Sajid Umar	English	Episode 1A: precise Shari’ah definitions of tazkiyyah, nafs, ruh	<u>Open</u>	
17	<u>Why Tazkiyah? What will it do to my life?</u>	Retreat lecture	English	Motivation for pursuing tazkiyah and inner connection	<u>Open</u>	
18	<u>Tazkiyah I — A Lecture Series (Playlist)</u>	Dr. Hatem AlHaj	English	Multi-part playlist on purification of the soul	<u>Open</u>	
19	<u>Heart Matters Series — Purification of the Soul</u>	Islamicity	English	<i>Text</i> — article companion to the video series (tazkiyah concept)	<u>Open</u>	

3. Levels / Stages of the Nafs

#	Title	Scholar / Speaker	Language	Short Description
20	<u>The 7 Levels of the Nafs — Level 1: Nafs al-Ammarah</u>	7 Levels series	English	Episode 1 of 7-part journey through spiritual purification and self-awareness
21	<u>The 3 Types of Nafs (Nafs al-Ammarah)</u>	Champion Method	English	The soul that pushes toward desires — resisting temptation (motivation) <i>Text — Ammarah – Lawwama – Mulhima → Mutmainna Radiya → Mardiyya → Kamila</i>
22	<u>The 7 Stages of the Nafs: A Clear Path to Improvement</u>	PurificationOfTheSoul.com	English	<i>Text — Q&A on nafs-e-ammara, lawwama, mutmainna with Quranic proofs</i>
23	<u>Understanding the Three Types of Nafs</u>	Zaynab Academy	English	<i>Text — 3 main Quranic types + jihad al-nafs; Tafseer references (Tabari, Baghawi)</i>
24	<u>The Meaning of Nafs and the Struggle Against the Lower Soul (Jihad al-Nafs)</u>	Sufi Path of Love	English	<i>Text — classical Sufi taxonomy of the 7 nafs levels</i>
25	<u>Explication of the Seven Levels of the Nafs</u>	Ibrahim Hakki Erzurumi (Jerrahi)	English	

4. Diseases of the Heart & Their Cures

#	Title	Scholar / Speaker	Language	Short Description
26	Arrogance & Envy — Diseases of the Heart Course	Shaykh Osamah	English	Course session on kibr (arrogance), hasad (envy)
27	Diseases of the Heart and Their Cure by Ibn Taymiyyah — Part 1	Ibn Taymiyyah (BKC)	English	Full playlist: https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL3JjyXeZUFqiqPsnBM4eo
28	Diseases of the Hearts and Their Cures (Book Study)	Imam Ibn Qayyim	English	<i>Text</i> — envy, desire, pride (kibr) and their cures
29	Spiritual Disease and Its Cure	Ibn Qayyim (Kalamullah)	English	<i>Text</i> — free PDF (260 pp): medicine for the heart, soul and body
30	Diseases of the Heart and Their Cures — Causes for Jealousy	Balagha.net	English	<i>Text</i> — covetousness, arrogance as the first sins; remedies
31	Overcoming Arrogance	Virtual Mosque	English	<i>Text</i> — kibr as the greatest disease of the heart; remedies

5. Supplementary & Related

#	Title	Scholar / Speaker	Language	Short Description	Link
32	What Controls the Human Heart? — Islam & Hard Questions Ep. 13	Islam & Hard Questions	English	Includes Ibn Arabi's map of the soul / seven levels of nafs	Open
33	The	Life With	English	<i>Text</i> — tazkiyat al-nafs as the	Open

	<u>Purification of the Soul</u>	Allah		greatest need of our time	
34	<u>An Islamic Model of the Heart & Soul</u>	Halaqa	English	<i>Text</i> — model: nafs as lower self, heart as inspired guide	<u>Open</u>
35	<u>Bilal Assad — Islamic Lectures (Playlist)</u>	Belal Assaad	English	Includes “The Soul & Self (Ruh & Nafs)” (540K views)	<u>Open</u>
36	<u>Spirituality, Tazkiyatun Nafs, and Obstacles to Spiritual Development</u>	Podcast (Class 25)	English	41 min — obstacles to spiritual development	<u>Open</u>

Key Concepts Quick Reference

- **Qalb (heart):** The spiritual center of perception and moral discernment; the seat of faith, sincerity, and intention. “Indeed, in the body there is a piece of flesh... it is the heart.” (Bukhari & Muslim)
- **Nafs (self/soul):** The ego-self with desires and inclinations; the battleground of spiritual struggle (jihad al-nafs).
- **Ruh (spirit):** The soul breathed from Allah; distinct from nafs in classical scholarship.
- **Three main Quranic stages of nafs:**
 1. **Nafs al-Ammarah** — the soul that commands evil (12:53)
 2. **Nafs al-Lawwama** — the self-reproaching soul (75:2)
 3. **Nafs al-Mutmainna** — the serene, content soul (89:27-30)
- **Tazkiyah (purification):** The process of purifying the nafs — the core of Islamic spiritual development.
- **Diseases of the heart:** Arrogance (kibr), envy (hasad), ostentation (riya’), anger, love of the world, heedlessness — and their cures per Ibn Qayyim & Ibn Taymiyyah.

Suggested Viewing Order

1. **Start:** #1–7 (Belal Assad — what nafs & ruh are; Tahirul Qadri — Urdu perspective)
2. **Deepen:** #16 (Sajid Umar — Shari’ah definitions), #20 (7 levels series)
3. **Purify:** #8–19 (tazkiyah lectures — Younis, Qadhi, Yusuf, AlHaj)
4. **Heal:** #26–31 (diseases of the heart & cures)
5. **Sustain:** #35–36 (playlists & ongoing series)